Interview: #3

Participant: person_3

Age: 54

Occupation/ situation: Purchaser

Interview method: Phone call

Cooking habits

1. How often do you cook?
- 1 time a week if I make the dinner.
2. What kind of meals do you usually cook?
- Dinner and breakfast are probably what get made.
3. How often do you use recipes when cooking?
- It depends on what I'm making, maybe half the time. Not breakfast, but dinner. Maybe a quarter, rather than half.
4. Where do you usually find recipes?
- Internet and books. Normal websites.
5. What device to you normally use when looking for recipes online?
- Phone and tablet.

Finding recipes

6. Imagine you want to find a recipe for dinner. How would you normally search for it?
- It depends on what I'm making. I simply go to Google, search for "chocolate cake recipe," and pick whatever comes up. Sometimes I turn to websites I'm already familiar with.
7. What information do you usually look for before deciding to make a recipe?
   - ☒ Ingredients
   - ☐ Preparation time
   - ☐ Cooking time
   - ☒ Difficulty
   - ☒ Number of servings
   - ☐ Dietary information
   - ☐ Calories/nutrition
   - ☒ Reviews/ratings

- ☒ Photos
- ☒ Other:
- If I have all the tools needed.

8. What makes you choose one recipe over another?

- The photos are important. They need to look good. There also needs to be a good description of how to do it, something relatively easy to pull off.

9. Are there any things you usually search for specifically? For example: gluten-free, vegetarian, cheap, quick, high-protein, etc.

- No I don't think so.

Frustrations

10. What annoys you about recipe websites or apps?

- The description might be bad. If they measure items like carrots, for instance, they specify "1 carrot" rather than a weight in grams. Carrots can vary significantly in size. Recipes are often written for people who have made the dish before. Measurements need to be precise.

11. Have you ever given up on using a recipe because the website/app was difficult to use? What happened?

- Uh, let's see. Not that I recall. I usually give up before I even start making it. For example, too many ingredients.

12. Is there anything you wish recipe websites did better?

- Well, maybe improve the search functions on the homepage. When you first arrive, you often have to hunt for the search bar. Some of the sites feel more like cooking projects than actual websites. Things can be hard to find. There needs to be an easier way to locate categories. They often just throw a bunch of suggestions onto the homepage, making it look cluttered. It gets a bit overwhelming.

Recipe information

13. What information would you want to see immediately when opening a recipe?

- It's about whether it's easy to get hold of, without having to visit 4 different stores to find everything. Or having to order it. It's much nicer to use standard items.

14. How important are serving sizes to you? Do you ever change them?

- No, I don't. It might be a good idea to decide how many to prepare. It's handy to have small, medium, and large portions.

15. How important is preparation/cooking time?

- If it's a dinner in the middle of the week, it's important. If it's cake or the weekend, it's not important.

16. How important are dietary tags or filters?
- It might be important or perhaps appreciated with a list option for allergies.
17. Would you use features such as saving recipes, favorites, shopping lists, or meal planning? Why/why not?
- I haven't used it so far, it's a bit like when your mother is working, I never know what we're going to eat. Planning further ahead is a bit difficult.

Open question

18. If you could design your ideal recipe website/app, what would it have?
- That would be incredibly simple, categories for weekday dinners, weekend dinners, cakes, and one for desserts. Nothing else needs to be listed there, you can look elsewhere for other things. A search bar would be good, too.
19. Is there anything else about finding or using recipes that you think would be useful for us to know?
- Hmm, that’s a good question. I’d have to give that some thought. Ranking high in Google searches.